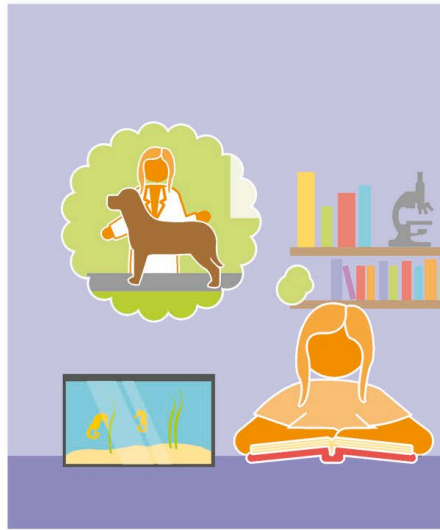


Taking action

Goals and ambitions should stretch a person, but at the same time, it's a good idea to think carefully about how realistic they are before throwing everything into pursuing them. Dividing a big ambition into smaller goals, actions, and targets helps to make it feel more achievable. Ambitions can change over time, so it's important for teens to reassess their plans now and then to see if they need or want to do things differently.

▷ Aim high

A goal or ambition can be achieved with persistence, dedication, and hard work.



TEEN HINTS

Not feeling sure

Some teens have a very strong sense of what their goals and ambitions are, but for many, it takes a lot longer to work out what excites them. This is completely normal, and there is no pressure to decide. Keeping your options open and trying out lots of different things allows you to find new interests and to discover in time what you feel passionate about, even if that doesn't happen until you're older.

Staying motivated

If a goal or ambition is the destination, then motivation is the fuel that keeps people going, even when things get tough. It's normal to feel frustrated or disheartened occasionally, but there are things people can think about to inspire and energize themselves.



GOOD TO KNOW

Visualization

- Visualize your goal in as much detail as possible. This can help you to see what practical steps you need to take to get there.
- Imagine how you might feel once you've achieved your goal, when things get tough. This can provide motivation.

▷ Celebrating victories

Whether achievements are big or small, they are a reason to be proud and to feel confident.



Celebrating success

Working toward and achieving a goal or ambition can be very satisfying. Knowing that it's possible to work hard, overcome challenges and obstacles, and accomplish something exciting can all help to boost confidence and self-esteem. If a person is working toward a big goal or ambition, it's important for them to celebrate the smaller successes along the way, too.

PARENT TIPS

Encountering failure

Falling short of achieving a goal or ambition can be very disappointing. Let your teen know that it may take longer than they'd like, but by learning from their mistakes, working out how to improve, and being persistent, they will get there in the end.